pages secure enough to access databases and other secure information. A lot of the syntax of PHP is borrowed from other languages such as C, Java and Perl. However, PHP has a number of unique features and specific functions as well. The goal of the language is to allow Web developers to write dynamically generated pages quickly and easily. PHP is also great for creating database-driven Web sites. If you would like to learn more about PHP, the official site is PHP.net.

The PHP Hypertext Preprocessor (PHP) is a programming language that allows web developers to create dynamic content that interacts with databases. PHP is basically used for developing web based software applications.

PHP is a script language and interpreter that is freely available and used primarily on Linux Web servers. PHP, originally derived from *Personal Home Page* Tools, now stands for *PHP: Hypertext Preprocessor*, which the PHP FAQ describes as a "recursive acronym."

PHP executes on the server, while a comparable alternative, JavaScript, executes on the client. PHP is an alternative to Microsoft's Active Server Page (ASP) technology. As with ASP, the PHP script is embedded within a Web page along with its HTML. Before the page is sent to a user that has requested it, the Web server calls PHP to interpret and perform the operations called for in the PHP script.

An HTML page that includes a PHP script is typically given a file name suffix of ".php" ".php7," or ".phtml". Like ASP, PHP can be thought of as "dynamic HTML pages," since content will vary based on the results of interpreting the script.

PHP is an open-source language, used primarily for dynamic web content and server-side applications. PHP is often pointed to as the main competitor with the following:

- Microsoft's C# — Visual Basic.NET — ASP family
- Sun's Java — JSP
- Macromedia's ColdFusion
- CGI — Perl

PHP has many open-source libraries included with the core build, and many more are readily available. Extensions exist to help it **interface** with a number of systems, including IRC, a number of compression formats, and Windows API.

Did You Know?

PHP was developed by Rasmus Lerdorf in 1995, and later it has been developed as open source. The PHP Group now manages the implementation of PHP.

Keyword

Interface is a shared boundary across which two or more separate components of a computer system exchange information.